

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 373

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to recognize Hurricane Baptist Church on the occasion of its 210th anniversary.

WHEREAS, the churches of our nation have been an integral part of our history as a people and have had an unparalleled impact in forming and maintaining a stable and just society; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should recognize those venerable religious institutions and their congregations who, through their unflagging capacity for love, dedication of spirit, and faith in God, strive to enrich the lives of people in their communities; and

WHEREAS, one such dynamic community of faith is Hurricane Baptist Church in Wilson County, whose members are celebrating the church's 210th anniversary this year; and

WHEREAS, the origins of Hurricane Baptist Church trace back to August 1815, when the church was constituted as Union Church with twenty-six founding members living in what is now known as the Hurricane community; and

WHEREAS, the church's first pastor, Joshua Lester, was born in Virginia on September 6, 1781, and became an ordained minister at the age of twenty; after settling in Wilson County in 1805, he played a crucial role in the establishment of Union Church, which he served as pastor from 1815 to 1822; and

WHEREAS, the second pastor, John Bond, moved with his family from South Carolina to Middle Tennessee in 1806 at the age of nineteen; an assistant to Joshua Lester, he was ordained to preach at Union Church in 1822; and

WHEREAS, Pastor Bond donated eleven acres of land to the church and helped construct a meeting house; he faithfully served the congregation for thirty-nine years until his passing on March 2, 1861; and

WHEREAS, the third pastor, Nathaniel Morgan Green, was born in Wilson County and raised in the Hurricane community; ordained in 1843, Elder Green began preaching at Union Church after the death of John Bond and continued to serve for nineteen years, until his own passing in 1880; and

WHEREAS, the church's name change from Union Church to Hurricane Baptist Church in October 1923 reflects a deep connection to the history of the community, as a powerful storm—likely a tornado, but referred to as a hurricane—once devastated the area a century earlier; and

WHEREAS, the congregation has worshiped in three different buildings since its founding: the original log meeting house of 1815, a two-story structure built in collaboration with the Masons, and the current building, which was constructed in 1907; and

WHEREAS, Hurricane Baptist Church is currently under the faithful and capable leadership of Pastor Kenneth M. Tramel; born in DeKalb County, he became an ordained minister in 1963 and served from 1984 to 2011 as campus minister for Cumberland University, where the Kenneth M. Tramel Baptist Student Center was named in his honor. Pastor Tramel began preaching at Hurricane Baptist Church in March 2010 and continues to serve the congregation to this day; and

WHEREAS, throughout its 210-year history, Hurricane Baptist Church has remained steadfast in its mission of faith, service, and fellowship, making an indelible impact on its members and the surrounding community; and

WHEREAS, Hurricane Baptist Church is truly one of the great religious institutions and catalysts for positive spiritual change in our State and nation, and the members of this exceptional congregation should be appropriately honored for their exemplary service to their fellow Christians and the good people of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we join in the celebration of the 210th anniversary of Hurricane Baptist Church, thank the good people of this historic congregation and their ministers for their notable service to their Lord and the State of Tennessee, and wish them much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.